Que, Pour L'amour de Dieu, Fait Quoi ?

Towards an Analysis of French Coordinated *Wh*-Questions

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1. Introduction

This paper unravels the puzzle of coordinated *wh*-questions (CWH) in French, a previous gap in the literature. The challenge of French CWH is rooted in the fact that French has two forms of the *wh*-word 'what': *que* and *quoi*. *Que* is generally taken to be a clitic which must attach to a verbal host; the specifics of this attachment will be discussed in section 2.[1] *Quoi* is taken to be the corresponding strong form (Bouchard & Hirschbuhler 1986; Poletto & Pollock 2005). *Que* is thus banned from *wh*-in-situ questions (1a), and *quoi* from *wh*-ex-situ (1b):

(1) a. Tu fais quoi/*que ?[2]
you do.PRS.2SG what[3]
'What are you doing?'

b. Que/*quoi fais=tu ?
what do.PRS.2SG=you
'What are you doing?'

In non-finite questions, *wh*-in-situ is banned. However, there is optionality between *que* and *quoi*:

(2) a. *Manger que/quoi ?
eat.INF what

b. Que/quoi manger?
what eat.INF
'What to eat?'

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[1] Good evidence for *que* being a clitic comes from the fact that it requires subject-verb inversion, unlike other *wh*-words:

i. a. *Que tu fais ?
What you do.PRS.2SG (Gotowski 2022: 9, ex. 26a)

b. Où tu vas ?
Where you go.PRS.2SG
'Where are you going?' (Gotowski 2022: 9, ex. 26b)

[2] All un-cited data is the author's own.

[3] 2 = Second person; 3 = Third person; IMP = imperfect; INF = non-finite; NEG= negation particle; PRS = present ; PTCP = past participle; REFL = reflexive; SG = singular

Finally, both *que* and *quoi* are banned as finite subjects:

(3) *Que/quoi flotte ?
what float.PRES.3SG

The picture becomes more complicated in CWH. In the coordinated context, *que* can be removed from a verbal host, violating the principle established by (1a):

(4) Que/quoi et où manger ?
what and where eat.INF
'What and where to eat?'

Note that *quoi* is also possible in (4), and that either *que* or *quoi* may also appear as the second conjunct, as in (5):

(5) Où et que/quoi manger ?
Where and what eat.INF
'Where and what to eat?'

As a second puzzle, *que* and *quoi* may also appear as the subject of non-finite questions:

(6) Qui et quoi flotte ?
who and what float.PRES.3SG
'Who and what floats?'

Here too, (6) seems to directly contradict the pattern established in non-coordinated questions. These observations raise the question: what is the structure of CWH in French, such as to permit these asymmetries? To my knowledge, the structure of French CWH has not been addressed in the literature.

In what follows, I propose that, by adopting two independently-motivated assumptions about spoken French, CWH with non-subject [wh] can be accounted for in a unified way that preserves the *que*/*quoi* typology of non-coordinated questions. However, the subject puzzle in (6) raises significant problems for this analysis and will probably need to be analyzed under a

separate coordination strategy. Section two outlines the *que/quoi* typology in greater detail. In section three, I then introduce the two pieces of theory necessary to my analysis: i) that French has *wh*-raising to [Spec, InfinP] (Richard Kayne 1991), and ii) that French has a bi-clausal, multi-dominant coordination structure (Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek 2013). In section four, I apply my proposal to French CWH with *que/quoi* non-subjects, demonstrating that it successfully accounts for the data. In section five, I turn my attention to *que/quoi* subjects, which raise significant theoretical issues. I conclude in section six by discussing the implications of these issues and directions for further research.

2. Conditioning environments for *que* and *quoi*

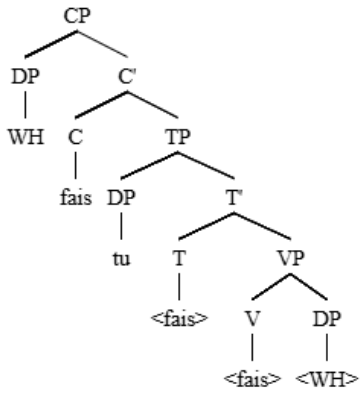
In this section, I outline the Vocabulary Insertion (VI) rules put forth by Gotowski (2022) to explain the conditioning environments for *que* and *quoi.* Under her Distributed Morphology analysis, Gotowski posits that [what] enters the derivation as a *wh*-feature bundle. Its morphological form at Spell-Out is conditioned by its environment; in keeping with the analysis of *que* as a clitic, Gotowski proposes that *que* surfaces when structurally adjacent to a complex C+V head (Gotowski 2022: 20). She formalizes this notion with the rules in (7)-(8):

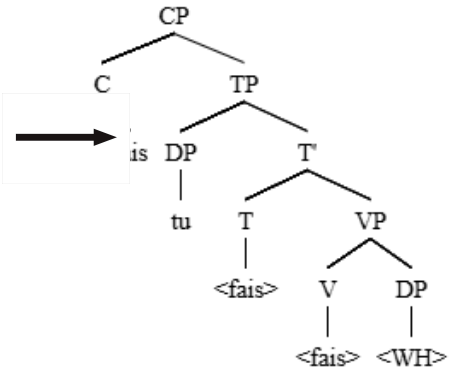
(7) [+wh, –human] ⇔ que/ [___+V] (Gotowski 2022: 23, ex. 66)

(8) [+wh, –human] ⇔ quoi/ elsewhere (Gotowski 2022: 25, ex. 70)

The complex C+V head is accomplished via m-merger, which stipulates that, after movement to a specifier, the merged head adjoins to the unmoved head (Matushansky 2006). Matushanky likewise proposes that m-merger targets maximal, non-projecting phrases in the same way that it targets heads. As such, [wh] merges from [Spec, CP] into the C+V head, creating the context for (7) to apply. This process is illustrated in (9) below:

(9) a. Before m-merger b. b. After m-merger





(Gotowski 2022: 22, ex. 65a) (Gotowski 2022: 22, ex. 65b)

Gotowski convincingly argues that these rules are necessary to understand French sluicing. They also provide a useful structural reflex of the notion of *que* as clitic. As such, I take compatibility with this process to be a starting point for my CWH analysis.

3. Key theoretical assumptions

In this section, I review the literature around two independently-motivated assumptions necessary to my analysis.

3.1 French has wh-movement to [Spec, InfnP]

In following Kayne (1991), I assume that French has an intermediate InfnP projection between VP and TP to which non-finite V moves:

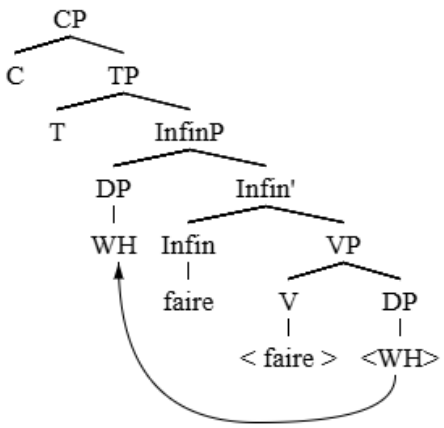
(10) …T … Cl + [$_{Infn}$ V + Infn] … [$_{vp}$[$_{v}$ e] … (Kayne 1991: 651, ex. 9)

The *Cl* in (10) represents a clitic, a point to which I will return shortly. Kayne's reasoning stems from Pollock's (1989) Split INFL hypothesis. In brief, Pollock observes that French has two possible landing sites for the verb relative to adverbs and negation, and thus that IP must consist of at least two I projections. Kayne further observes that clitics need a free (non-trace) I node to adjoin to, and that neither Pollock's AGRP nor TP are suitable candidates. He also notes that the

combination of finite verb + clitic is unattested in French, but that infinitive + clitic is permitted (Kayne 1991: 650). He thus motivates the additional inflectional layer Infn, which gives clitics a head to adjoin to in nonfinite, but not finite, contexts.[4]

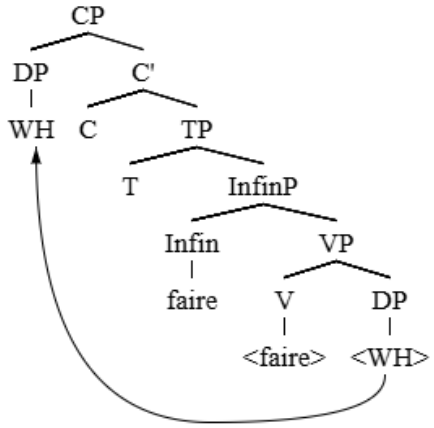
Gotowski (2022) takes Kayne's InfnP as her starting point and additionally proposes that the [wh] feature bundle may optionally move to [Spec, InfnP] instead of [Spec, CP]. When in [Spec, InfnP], the [wh] undergeo m-merger and surface as *que* (11a)*;* when in [Spec, CP] it is not local enough to the verb for (7) to apply (11b). Note that these trees represent the structure before m-merger for clarity; *faire* is a non-finite verb:

(11) a. [wh] in [Spec, InfnP] derives *que*



(Gotowski 2022: 30, ex. 84)

b. [wh] in [Spec, CP] derives *quoi*



(Gotowski 2022: 31, ex. 85)

The free alternation between *que* and *quoi* in (2b), can thus be explained as optionality of movement, analogous to the optionality of movement between finite *wh*-in-situ and *wh*-ex-situ in (1) (Gotowski 2022: 31).[5] Although the source of this optionality remains unclear, it is a much more satisfactory theory than what had been previously assumed, namely that: "the distribution of que and quoi in infinitival clauses is rather ad hoc in itself… Synchronically, this is just an

[4] See (Kayne 1991: 648-657) for a much more thorough explanation.
[5] Gotowski assumes generally that this movement is feature-driven; I leave it as an open question how exactly the location of a [+WH] probe would interact with this optionality.

odd fact" (Bouchard & Hirschbuehler 1986: 52).

I adopt Gotowksi's optional *wh*-movement to [Spec, InfnP] in what follows. However, it is interesting to note that Kayne's structure in (10) equally-well predicts that *que* cliticizes to the infinitive at a projection below TP. In later work, Poletto & Pollock (2005) make this prediction even more explicit: "we should also expect to find *wh*-clitics targeting the IP (pronominal) clitic field; we claim that the (only) target for *wh*-words *qua* clitics is the topmost layer in the IP clitic field, immediately below the subject position" (Poletto & Pollock 2005: 140). They formalize this with the structure in (12):

(12) $[_{IP}$ Subject $[_{\textit{Wh}\text{-clitic position}}$ que $[_{\text{neg. clitic position}}$ ne [….. [VP]]]]]

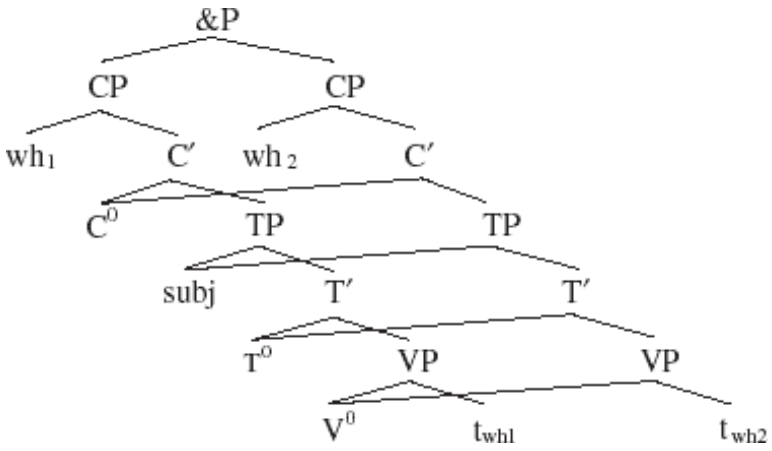
(Poletto & Pollock 2005: 140, ex. 12)

Although it is unclear exactly how these proposals interact with the mechanics of Gotowski's (2022) VI rules (an issue to be returned to in section 5.2), there is clearly broad support for *que* (but not *quoi*) being lower than [Spec, CP] in non-finite questions.

3.2 French has a bi-clausal, multi-dominant, non-bulk sharing coordinate structure

In Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek (2013), the authors posit a cross-linguistic typology of three structures for coordinated *wh*-questions: mono-clausal, bi-clausal with bulk sharing (I.E., the sharing of entire constituents), and bi-clausal with non-bulk sharing (I.E., the sharing of multiple individual nodes). I suggest that their bi-clasual structure with non-bulk sharing, illustrated in (13) below, is the only one applicable to French. Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek propose four diagnostics for determining a language's place in the typology: the availability of multiple *wh*-fronting, the possibility of conjoining arguments, grammaticality with an obligatorily transitive verb, and superiority effects (Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek 2013: 21). Across all four, French is consistent with the bi-clausal, non-bulk sharing analysis; a discussion of just two suffices here.

(13) Bi-clausal, non-bulk sharing CWH



(Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek 2013: 4, ex. 6c)

As a first diagnostic, French disallows the coordination of two *wh*-arguments:[6]

(14) *Où et quoi tu as mis ?
where and what you have.PRS.2SG put.PTCP

The ungrammaticality of the ditransitive *mettre* 'put' suggests that *où* et *quoi* are not arguments of a single verb, but instead are generated in separate VPs. French must thus have a bi-clausal coordination structure.

Second, French disallows CWHs with obligatorily transitive verbs. Contrast the ungrammaticality of *acheter* 'buy' in (15a) with *manger* 'eat' in (5), repeated as (15b):

(15) a. *Où et que/quoi acheter?
Where and what buy.INF

b. Où et que/quoi manger ?
Where and what eat.INF
'Where and what to eat?'

[6] Discussion in this section is partially adapted from the discussion of English in (Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek 2020: 3–5)

This contrast motivates the analysis that French is non-bulk sharing; *où* cannot be interpreted as an argument, which is to say, *où et quoi* does not form a constituent. French's place is then typology is thus made clear.

I note here that, following (Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek 2013), the purpose of my CWH proposal is not to defend the existence of multidominance in the grammar generally. The proposal simply provides one example of where multidominance is useful.

3.4 Interim summary

Thus far, I have argued three assumptions to be true: i) *que* is a clitic which is derived via m-merger when structurally adjacent to a verbal host, ii) French has obligatory V raising to InfnP for non-finite verbs and optional *wh*-raising to [Spec, InfnP], and iii) French employs a bi-clausal non-bulk sharing coordination strategy. In what follows, I argue that these latter two assumptions are sufficient to explain the data in a way consistent with the first.

4. Application of the proposal to *wh-non-subject* questions.

4.1 The proposal

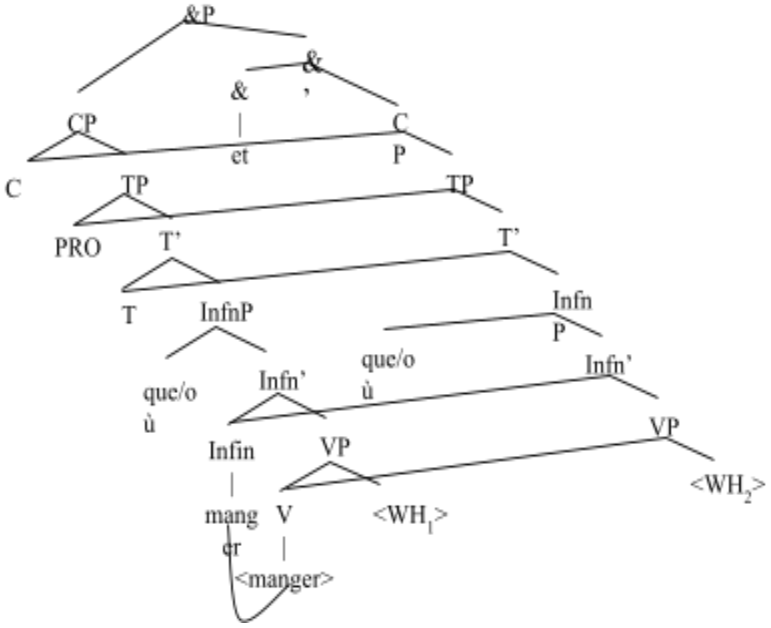
In this section, I demonstrate that my proposal straightforwardly accounts for the alternation between *que* and *quoi* in CWH with *wh*-non-subjects. Note that I have again chosen in this section to draw trees before m-merger applies. It does, in fact, remain an open question how m-merger might apply in multidominant contexts. I return to this question in section (4.3); for now I assume that m-merger is available when *que* is either the first or second conjunct.[7]

I propose that non-finite questions with *que* have the structure in (16). Just as in non-coordinated questions, assuming InfnP creates the local environment for *que* to surface. Crucially, assuming a multidominant structure here allows for *que* to be in an equally local

[7]Alternatively, one might reconceptualize Gotowski's VI rules to depend on a spec-head relationship between [wh] and V instead of an m-merged relationship. To the best of my understanding, this would not significantly impact her analysis.

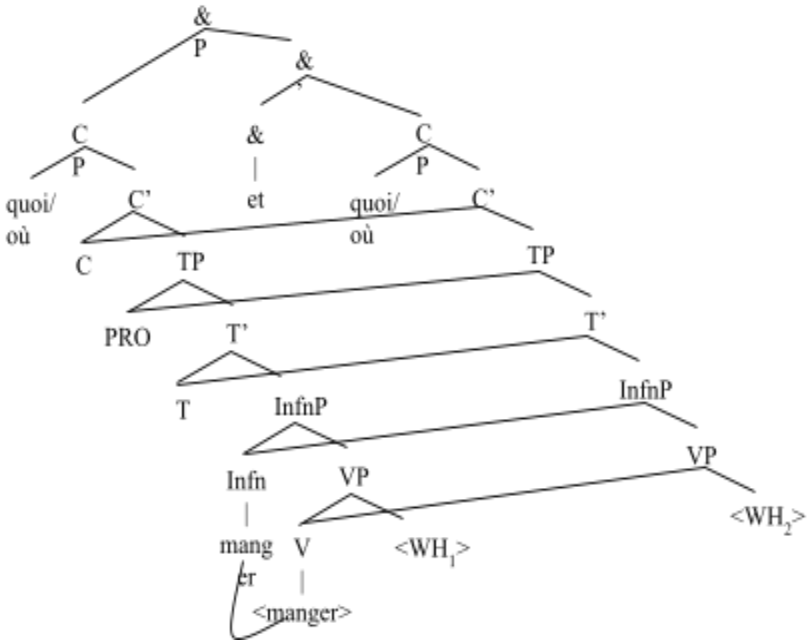
relationship to the verb as either the first or second conjunct. The mystery of how *que* surfaces when not linearly adjacent to the verb, as in (4), is thus resolved.

(16) Que et où manger ? / Où et que manger ?



The story is much the same for non-finite questions with *quoi*. I assume the structure in (17):

(17) Quoi et où manger ? / Où et quoi manger ?



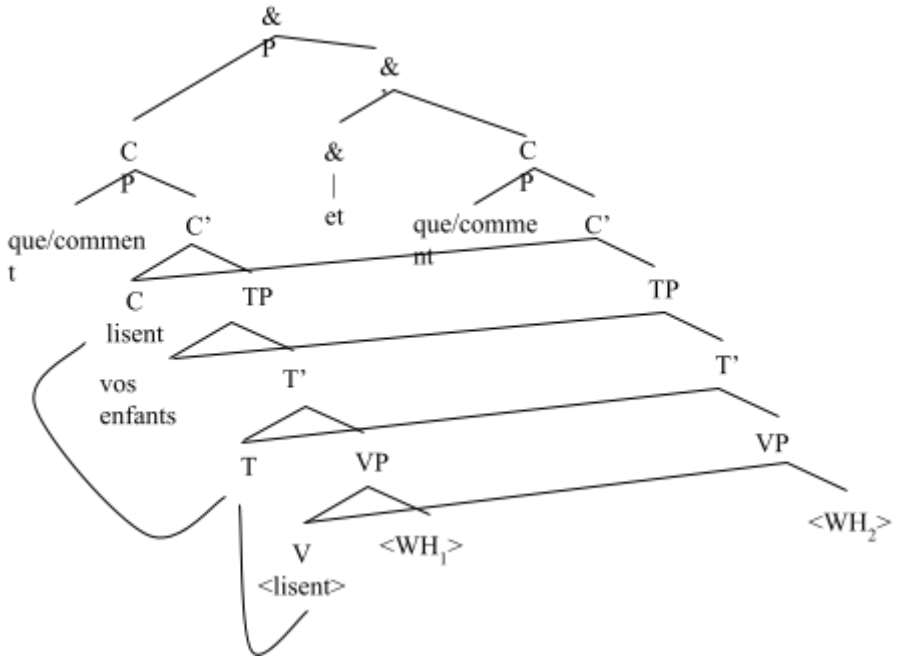
In (17), the [wh] feature bundle has moved to [Spec, CP]. Neither the first nor second [wh] is local to the Infn, explaining how *quoi* is possible as either conjunct.

(18) is an example of a finite question with a *que* object:

(18) Que et comment lisent vos enfants ?
what and how read.PRS.3PL your children
'What and how do your children read?'

In these questions, T raises to C and [wh] moves to [Spec, CP]:

(19) Que et comment lisent vos enfants ?



Importantly, when T raises to C in finite questions, the only possible landing site for [wh] is [Spec, CP]. This should mean that *quoi* is blocked as an object in finite questions, since [wh] must end up locally to the verb as either conjunct. And indeed, this is what we see:

(20) *Quoi et comment lisent vos enfants ?
What and how read.PRS.3PL your children

The combination of InfnP and a multidominant CWH structure thus successfully accounts for all four permutations of *que/quoi* with finite and non-finite non-subject questions.

4.2 Nuancing the data

There is one piece of data that still cannot be accounted for under this proposal. Native speaker consultation yields a more complex paradigm than the simple *que/quoi* alternation in non-finite questions above:[8]

(21) a. ✓que manger?
b. ? quoi manger ?
c. ✓✓ où et quoi manger ?
d. ✓ quoi et où manger ?
e. ? que et où manger ?
f. ? où et que manger ?

Que is preferred over *quoi* in non-coordinated questions. In coordinated questions, however, the opposite is true; *quoi* is preferred and is especially preferred as the second conjunct. Why should this be?

4.3 An elaborated proposal

I begin by addressing the alternation between (21a) and (21b). I propose that this preference actually falls out naturally from Economy of Derivation as expressed in (Chomsky 1995), namely that "derivations contain no superfluous steps" (Chomsky 1995: 84). Here, this constraint could be specifically formulated as the generalization (22), assuming that [wh] passes through [Spec InfnP] on its way to [Spec, CP] via successive cyclic movement[9]:

(22) Movement to [Spec, CP] is dispreferred when [Spec, InfnP] is available.

The fact that the contrast between (21a) and (21b) can be explained via economy of movement seems like good continuing evidence for what we have assumed to this point: that *que* and *quoi* occupy distinct structural positions in non-finite questions.

The question does of course remain why *quoi* is available at all, if less derivationally

[8] Many thanks to Simon Bouriat-Hardouin, French language associate at Carleton College, for offering his judgments.
[9] I again set aside the specifics of this movement, assuming broadly that it is feature-driven.

economical than *que.* I propose that this may simply be stylistic, Chomsky reflecting: "Any remaining examples of optional rule application would then have to be assigned to some other component of the language system, perhaps a 'stylistic' component of the mapping of S-Structure to PF (Chomsky 1995: 133). If we take economy to be a preference instead of a hard constraint on derivations, a strong stylistic motivation for *quoi* should be sufficient for (21b) to surface.

I turn now to the question of why *quoi* is preferred in non-finite CWH (21c-f). For this to be the case, there must be a stronger constraint, either stylistic or structural, than (22). And indeed, there is a natural candidate: clitics cannot be coordinated (Poletto & Pollock 2005: 138). Reformulating this as a constraint instead of a hard ban, and "ranking" this constraint as more important than (22) yields the desired paradigm where *que* is preferred in single questions and is dispreferred (but not banned) in CWH.

As for why *quoi* is preferred as the second conjunct, I appeal to phonology. It may simply be that the vowel sequences /e u/, as in *et où,* or /a e/, as in *quoi et*, are dispreferred in French. Future research would do well to investigate whether the contrast holds, for example, with *quoi et comment,* or with an /e/-initial verb. Likewise, it is worth noting that my consultation with a single speaker obscures any kind of possible socio- or stylistic variation in the data, which could also be at play here.

As a final possibility, it is intriguing to note that two experimental studies of CWH in English have found a preference for *what* as the second conjunct (Lewis et al. 2012; Lewis et al. 2013; Whitman 2004, as cited in Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek 2020). These studies specifically looked at the (marginal) acceptability of CWH with obligatorily transitive verbs:

(23) a. When and what did John fix?
b. *What and when did John fix?

(Lewis et al. 2013, as cited in Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek 2020: 4, ex. i)

This preference is fairly well explained by processing considerations. Although (23) clearly represents a different issue at stake than the contrast between (21c) and (21d), it is interesting to think that the preference for *what* as the second conjunct may be due to some sort of universal constraint.

In any case, the contrast does not seem to demand a structural justification. Our combination of VI rules, InfnP, and bi-clausal coordination strategy again emerge as sufficient to explain the facts of French CWH.

5. Wh-subjects

I now turn my attention to *que/quoi* subjects, which pose some serious challenges for the analysis.

5.1 Reviewing the data

To briefly review, *que* and *quoi* seem to be banned as finite subjects (3) but allowed as coordinated subjects (6). Native speaker consultation again yields a more nuanced paradigm:

(24) a. *que flotte?
b. *que et qui flotte ?
c. *qui et que flotte ?
d. *quoi flotte ?
e. ? quoi et qui flotte ?
f. ✓qui et quoi flotte ?

Que is universally banned as a subject in (24a-c). *Quoi* is banned as a single subject (23d), marginal as the first conjunct (24e), and fully acceptable as the second conjunct (24f). This asymmetry is also extremely well-attested in Sketch Engine's frTenTen corpus of Internet French (Kilgarriff et al. 2014; Miloš Jakubíček et al. 2013). Note that incompatibility with the subject position is not a characteristic of *wh*-words generally; other *wh*-words are perfectly acceptable as subjects (25):

(25) Qui flotte ?
who float.PRES.3SG
'Who floats?'

The ungrammaticality in (25) thus seems to be a property of 'what' specifically.

5.2 Notions of specificity in non-coordinated questions

A useful first step towards understanding this data is by appealing to the notion of subject specificity. Plunkett (1996; 2000) observes that "non-specific indefinites are at best marginal in matrix canonical subject positions" (Plunkett 2000: 528). She offers the example:

(26) a. ?*Un médecin est entré
A doctor is come in (Plunkett 2000: 528, ex. 27a)

b. Il y a un médecin qui se libère
it there has a doctor that REFL liberate
'A doctor is just becoming available' (Plunkett 2000: 528, ex. 27b)

The unspecified nature of *un médecin* in (26a) means that it cannot be in [Spec, TP]; embedding the subject in an expletive construction as in (26b) is necessary to make the non-specific subject acceptable. As inherently non-specific words, it thus falls out that *que* and *quoi* cannot normally surface as subjects. And yet, one problem immediately emerges: under our analysis, *quoi* is not in [Spec, TP]; being in the canonical subject position would trigger the environment for *quoi:*

(27) a. *[$_{CP}$ quoi [$_{C}$ [$_{TP}$ [t_{wh} [$_{T}$ flotte]]]]

b. *[$_{CP}$ [$_{C}$ [$_{TP}$ que [$_{T}$ flotte]]]]

We could consider revising Plunkett's generalization to (28):

(28) Non-specific subjects are banned from [Spec, TP] *at any point in the derivation*.

The generalization in (28) suffices to explain the *que/quoi* subject ban in non-coordinated questions. Yet attempting to explain CWH reveals an even more grave complication.

5.2. Quoi subjects are in [Spec, TP]

Explaining the grammaticality of the CWH (24f) requires stipulating that *quoi* may be made specific under the right discourse context. Plunkett (1996) alludes to this possibility: "Clearly, some indefinites may appear in subject position in French, but it may be that que/quoi are so resistant to a specific interpretation that, except where no other interpretation is available, as in an echo, it is rejected in [Spec,IP]" (Plunkett 1996: 293). She supports this observation with the (marginal) grammaticality of (29), where the embedded context has *quoi* necessarily referring to a member of a pre-delimited set:

(29) a. ?Qui a dit que quoi traînait où ?
Who has.PRS.3SG say.PTCP that what lie.around.IMP where
'Who said that what was lying around where?' (Plunkett 2000: 514, ex. 11)

In (29), however, there is no choice but to analyze *quoi* as in [Spec, TP]; it appears to the right of C and, even if in some lower projection of [Spec, CP], would violate the doubly-filled COMP filter. It is equally worth noting that any instance of a *quoi* subject in [Spec, CP] would violate Chomsky's 1986 Vacuous Movement Hypothesis (VMH), which stipulates that *wh*-subjects remain in [Spec, TP]. These facts render the stipulation in (28) a moot point, and they stack up convincingly to suggest that *quoi* as subject is in [Spec, TP].

There is simply no way for Gotowski's (2022) VI rules, repeated below, to account for this when V is in T:

(30) [+wh, –human] ⇔ que/ [___+V] (Gotowski 2022: 23, ex. 66)

(31) [+wh, –human] ⇔ quoi/ elsewhere (Gotowski 2022: 25, ex. 70)

One potential solution would be to posit that (30) and (31) only apply to [wh] feature bundles which are somehow object-marked. Yet Gotowski proposes the VI rules specifically in service of a sluicing analysis, and *quoi* subjects are possible in sluices:

(32) Quelque chose flotte, mais je ne sais pas quoi
Some thing float.PRS.3SG but I NEG know not what
'Something is floating, but I don't know what'

This data thus makes it seem like the VI rules need to be revisited entirely. This is puzzling, especially given the success of the rules in explaining both sluicing and the object paradigm in section 4. I present a few potential solutions in my conclusion; for now I take this to be the major open question in this research.

5.3 Returning to the que/quoi subject alternation

Let us turn finally, for the sake of completeness, to the data in (24), repeated below:

(33)
a. *que flotte?
b. *que et qui flotte ?
c. *qui et que flotte ?
d. *quoi flotte ?
e. ? quoi et qui flotte ?
f. ✓qui et quoi flotte ?

Even remaining agnostic to the structural conditions for *que/quoi*, this data proves equally difficult to explain.

Recall from (29) that *quoi* may surface as a subject when context gives it a specific interpretation. As a clitic, *que* is inherently light; it thus falls out that it will never be able to carry the semantic weight required for specificity. Turning to (33d-f), however, the contrast cannot be attributed to interpretation because, per (Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek 2013), "Related to our view of how the structure-building proceeds is the as that each conjunct is also interpreted separately before the meaning of the two is combined" (Citko & Gračanin-Yuksek 2013: 8). Which is to say: no explanation can be predicated on the notion that *quoi* is given a more specific interpretation by virtue of being in a conjunct.

The only way to create a contrast, then, is to imagine that French employs a bulk-sharing coordination structure with subject *wh*-questions where the two coordinated *wh*-words form a single (specific) constituent. Note that a mono-clausal analysis is not viable because it is only

available for multiple *wh*-fronting languages, which French is not (Gračanin-Yuksek 2017: 29). Analyzing *qui et quoi* as a single subject constituent also interacts oddly, however, with the fact that *qui et quoi* attracts singular agreement on the verb, a fact again corroborated consistently by corpus data. In the face of such contradictions, I must leave this question for future research.

As a final, more promising note, the contrast between (33e) and (33f) should not be structural in any way, and it mirrors the preference for *quoi* as the second conjunct found in non-finite questions (21). This seems to be good evidence for the phonological or stylistic analyses posited in that section.

6. Conclusion

In this paper, I have explored possible structures for CWH with *que* and *quoi* in French. CWH with 'what' non-subjects are straightforward to explain by adopting InfnP and a bi-clausal non-bulk sharing structure. Coordinated *que/quoi* subjects, however, raise a host of issues for facts previously assumed to hold for spoken French. Of these, the most pressing are: can Gotowski's (2022) VI rules be salvaged in the face of *quoi* subjects, or is a new analysis of French sluicing called for? And: can the bi-clausal, non-bulk sharing analysis be made to work for *que/quoi* subjects? I reflect briefly on these two points.

As for Gotowski's VI rules, I find that the facts point towards a need for revision. The failure with subject *quoi* is a starting point, but the rules also introduce the issue of multi-dominant m-merger, plus they ignore the idea of a structural clitic position which works well for (Poletto & Pollock 2005) and (Kayne 1991). I find it more logical to imagine that cliticization happens while the verb is adjacent to the clitic in TP and that the clitic subsequently moves to C with the verb. The underlying notion, however, that the form of [wh] is dependent on structural adjacency to the verb at some point, remains key to explaining CWH facts.

Incorporating the context of a clitic projection into Gotowski's existing VI rules may be a useful path forward.

On the other hand, I find myself more inclined to believe that a bi-clausal non-bulk sharing structure can be made to work across the board for French. This intuition stems from the observation: there are no cases where *quoi* is preferred as the first conjunct but *que* as the second, or vice versa. It thus seems logical that both conjuncts should occupy the same position relative to the verb, which is a notion that multidominance helpfully captures. Future research should, then, attempt to motivate the contrast in (33) in a non-structural way.

A useful starting point for this task, and for all other questions raised in this paper, would of course be to begin with more data than this paper has been able to provide. Consulting with a wider range of native speakers and in a wider range of contexts will be necessary to better understand what stylistic factors are at play. Looking at contrasts that could emerge from coordination with different *wh*-words, different conjunctions, and different verbs likewise seems fruitful. Finally, examining how these questions interact with adverb and negation placement will be important to any thorough analysis and eventual solution to the puzzle raised in this paper.

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